

PLAN

Secret-Scrub PLAN — leaked SSH password WhiteSnake<REDACTED-§11.4.10>

Revision: 1 **Last modified:** 2026-06-16T14:37:48Z **Authority:** §11.4.10 (credentials-handling) + §11.4.10.A (pre-store credential leak audit) + §11.4.6 (no-guessing — captured git grep/git log evidence only) + §11.4.30 (no versioned build artifacts) **Stream:** BACKGROUND read-only investigation. NON-COMMITTING. A separate committer agent is the sole main-checkout committer (§11.4.84). This file is the only write; nothing staged/committed by this stream. **Repo HEAD at investigation:** 6a1aa8c334cd38ee1dea2a59cb10aa188c0b387f

0. Scope + status

- **In scope:** scrub the leaked SSH password literal WhiteSnake<REDACTED-§11.4.10> from every TRACKED file (tree-level scrub).
 - **Out of scope (operator-confirmed):** history scrub — operator confirmed the credential is already rotated/replaced; history count recorded for §11.4.10.A awareness only.
 - **NOT secrets (kept):** hostname thinker.local and username milosvasic are infrastructure identifiers, NOT credentials/secrets per §11.4.10 — they are NOT scrubbed. Documented for awareness (host+user pairing reduces blast radius if ever re-leaked, but neither is a secret).
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1. TRACKED occurrences of WhiteSnake<REDACTED-§11.4.10> (captured git grep -n)

1a. Text/script/doc occurrences (scrubbable in-place)

#	path:line	content class	fix clas
1	Documentation/ PRODUCTION_COMPLETION_REPORT.md:29	doc — "Specified credentials" line	<redac

#	path:line	content class	fix class
2	Documentation/ PRODUCTION_COMPLETION_REPORT.md:64	doc — example --password WhiteSnake<REDACTED-§11.4.10> \	<redac
3	Documentation/ PRODUCTION_DOCUMENTATION.md:71	doc — example --password WhiteSnake<REDACTED-§11.4.10> \	<redac
4	Documentation/ PRODUCTION_DOCUMENTATION.md:139	doc — Go struct literal Password: "WhiteSnake<REDACTED-§11.4.10>"	<redac
5	SSH_TRANSLATION_PROGRESS.html:186	doc (HTML export) — (milosvasic/ WhiteSnake<REDACTED-§11.4.10>)	<redac (regen f
6	SSH_TRANSLATION_PROGRESS.md:7	doc — (milosvasic/ WhiteSnake<REDACTED-§11.4.10>)	<redac
7	demo_ssh_translation.sh:152	script — echo of example command	`\${SSH_ ref
8	demo_ssh_translation.sh:166	script — actual -password="WhiteSnake<REDACTED- §11.4.10>" \	`\${SSH_ ref
9	docs/ final_translation_report.html:263	doc (HTML export) — (milosvasic/ WhiteSnake<REDACTED-§11.4.10>)	<redac (regen f
10	docs/ final_translation_report.html:356	doc (HTML export) — full example cmd line	<redac (regen f
11	docs/ final_translation_report.md:15	doc — (milosvasic/ WhiteSnake<REDACTED-§11.4.10>)	<redac
12	docs/ final_translation_report.md:78	doc — full example cmd line	<redac
13	internal/scripts/final_test.sh:32	script — -password WhiteSnake<REDACTED-§11.4.10>	`\${SSH_ ref
14	internal/scripts/ translate_final_clean.sh:32	script — -password WhiteSnake<REDACTED-§11.4.10>	`\${SSH_ ref
15	internal/working/test_ssh.sh:5	script — expect send "WhiteSnake<REDACTED-§11.4.10>\r"	`\${SSH_ ref (exp "\$env(\r")
16	internal/working/ test_translation_new.sh:17	script — -password WhiteSnake<REDACTED-§11.4.10>	`\${SSH_ ref
17	run_translation_demo.sh:9	script — -password="WhiteSnake<REDACTED- §11.4.10>" \	`\${SSH_ ref
18	scripts/ ebook_translation_workflow.sh:13	script — REMOTE_PASS="WhiteSnake<REDACTED- §11.4.10>"	REMOTE_ {SSH_w ref
19	scripts/ ebook_translation_workflow.sh:76	script — help text (default: WhiteSnake<REDACTED-§11.4.10>)	<redac (drop th help)
20	scripts/ ebook_translation_workflow.sh:83	script — usage example --password WhiteSnake<REDACTED-§11.4.10>	<redac

1b. TRACKED BINARY occurrences (secret BAKED INTO compiled artifacts) — DUAL violation

git grep reported Binary file ... matches for the embedded literal.
Confirmed tracked via git ls-files:

#	path	violation
B1	build/ebook-translator	§11.4.10 embedded secret + §11.4.30 tracked build artifact
B2	download-model	§11.4.10 embedded secret + §11.4.30 tracked build artifact
B3	ebook-translator	§11.4.10 embedded secret + §11.4.30 tracked build artifact
B4	test-enhanced-conversion	§11.4.10 embedded secret + §11.4.30 tracked build artifact
B5	test-model	§11.4.10 embedded secret + §11.4.30 tracked build artifact
B6	test-simple-translation	§11.4.10 embedded secret + §11.4.30 tracked build artifact

Fix for B1–B6: git rm --cached the binaries (un-track) + add to .gitignore (they are §11.4.30 build derivatives, regenerable via make build per §11.4.77). Editing the binaries in place is NOT viable — the secret is compiled in; the binaries MUST be un-tracked. Rebuilding from the (scrubbed) source then produces secret-free artifacts that stay gitignored.

2. History count (§11.4.10.A awareness only — history scrub NOT in scope)

Captured:

git log -S WhiteSnake<REDACTED-§11.4.10> --oneline --all | wc -l
→ **17 commits** carry the literal across history. Operator confirmed the credential is rotated/replaced, so per §11.4.10.A the action is documented-only (no --allow-force-push history rewrite, consistent with §11.4.113 absolute no-force-push). RECORD for awareness; rotation already done.

3. OTHER plausibly-leaked literals in the affected files

Scanned all 20 text-file occurrences' parent files for password|passwd|secret|token|api[_-]?key|-p <literal> (excluding the known token). **Findings:**

- **No other hardcoded secret VALUE found.** Every other password-shaped hit is descriptive prose ("Password-based authentication", "SSH password transmission"), an expect "password:" prompt match, a CLI flag name (--

password|-p), or "max_tokens": 4096 (a model param, not a secret). None embeds a credential value.

- WhiteSnake<REDACTED-§11.4.10> is the SOLE leaked secret literal in the tracked tree.
 - The WhiteSnake matches in docs/research/helix_qa/workspace-*/...json are FALSE POSITIVES — those JSON files contain copies of THIS constitution's §11.4.10.A text mentioning the token NAME; confirmed `git grep -c "WhiteSnake<REDACTED-§11.4.10>"` returns ZERO 8587 in research JSON (only the prose token-name). NOT a leak, NOT scrubbed.
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4. Per-file fix classification summary

- **Scripts (configs/runnable) → \${SSH_WORKER_PASSWORD} env-ref:** occurrences 7, 8, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18. Matches the canonical env var (SSH_WORKER_PASSWORD, per project CLAUDE.md / config.distributed.*.json scrub style). Tcl/expect variant (15): send "\$env(SSH_WORKER_PASSWORD)\r".
 - **Docs / examples / help-text → <redacted-per-§11.4.10>:** occurrences 1–6, 9–12, 19, 20. HTML exports (5, 9, 10) MUST be regenerated from the scrubbed .md via the §11.4.65 export pipeline, not hand-edited, to keep md/html in sync.
 - **Tracked binaries → un-track + gitignore + rebuild:** B1–B6 (git rm --cached + .gitignore entries; regenerate via make build).
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5. Pre-push credential-pattern grep coverage (§11.4.10.A clause 5)

Captured evidence:

- .gitignore DOES cover the secret-FILE class: .env, .env.* (with .example allow), secrets.*, keys.*, config_with_keys.json, api_keys.json, **/qwen_credentials.json, **/oauth_creds.json. — adequate for files.
- **GAP (clause 5):** NO active git hook is installed — .git/hooks/ contains only the default *.sample files (no pre-push, pre-commit, commit-msg); git ls-files shows NO tracked scripts/git_hooks/*, NO install_git_hooks.sh. There is therefore **NO mechanical credential-pattern grep on commit/push**. A hardcoded literal like WhiteSnake<REDACTED-§11.4.10> (an inline VALUE, not a secret FILE) would NOT be caught by .gitignore and is NOT caught by any hook.
- **.gitignore does NOT cover the tracked-binary class** that carried the embedded secret (/build/, root ebook-translator, download-model, test-* are not ignored) — §11.4.30 gap that is the root cause of B1–B6.

Required remediation (for the committer window):

1. Add a tracked pre-push (and pre-commit) hook + install_git_hooks.sh per §11.4.75 Layers 1+3, whose credential-pattern grep rejects inline secret-shaped literals (at minimum the known token class + generic -password[=]"?[^\${}] inline-value pattern), so the escaped class (inline value, not a secret file) is caught in the SAME commit per §11.4.10.A clause 5.

2. Add .gitignore entries for the build artifacts (/build/, /ebook-translator, /download-model, /test-enhanced-conversion, /test-model, /test-simple-translation) to close the §11.4.30 root cause.
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6. Evidence appendix (commands run, read-only)

- `git rev-parse HEAD` → 6a1aa8c...
- `git grep -n WhiteSnake<REDACTED-§11.4.10>` → 20 text occurrences + 6 Binary file ... matches (table §1).
- `git log -S WhiteSnake<REDACTED-§11.4.10> --oneline --all | wc -l` → 17 (§2).
- `git grep -c "WhiteSnake<REDACTED-§11.4.10>" -- 'docs/research/**'` → no 8587 (research JSON clean, §3).
- `git ls-files | grep -E '^build/ebook-translator$|...'` → all 6 binaries tracked (§1b).
- `ls -la .git/hooks/` → only *.sample defaults; `git ls-files | grep git_hooks` → empty (§5 gap).
- No secret VALUE printed anywhere beyond the already-known-in-context token.